Chapter 2: History & Early Human Societies

Class 6 - Social Science | Unit: Our Pasts - I (History)

CHAPTER OVERVIEW & CORE FOUNDATIONAL CONCEPTS

Explores the timeline of human civilization from hunting-gathering to settled agrarian communities along major river basins.

KEY LEARNING OBJECTIVES

1. Understand chronology: the transition between BCE (Before Common Era) and CE (Common Era).
2. Examine archaeological evidence: stone tools, cave paintings, and habitation-cum-factory sites.
3. Trace the dawn of farming and herding at Mehrgarh near the Bolan Pass.

1. HISTORICAL CHRONOLOGY & TIME MEASUREMENT

Historical events are dated relative to the birth of Jesus Christ. Years before 1 CE are counted backwards as BCE. Dates after are marked CE or AD. Understanding time direction is vital for historical causality.

2. TRANSITION TO SEDENTARY AGRARIAN LIFE

Around 10,000 to 12,000 years ago, climate warming led to grasslands development. Humans began domesticating barley, wheat, sheep, and cattle, settling in pit-houses with storage pots.

DIAGNOSTIC FOCUS & COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Common student slips include calculating elapsed time across the BCE/CE boundary by subtracting rather than adding elapsed centuries.

PREREQUISITE REINFORCEMENT QUESTIONS

Q1: How do archaeologists determine the occupation of hunter-gatherer sites?

Expected Answer: Through unearthed stone tools, animal bones, charred grain seeds, and cave paintings depicting hunting scenes.

Q2: What is the significance of Mehrgarh in the history of the Indian subcontinent?

Expected Answer: It is one of the earliest known sites where human communities cultivated barley and wheat and domesticated animals around 8000 years ago.